

United Overseas Bank (UOBH.SI)

Earnings Review: Cutting EPS post 2Q, still hopeful for flat DPS amid strong capital; Buy

Buy

UOBH.SI 12m Price Target: **\$S\$42.70** Price: **\$S\$35.81** Upside: **19.2%**

UOB posted 2Q25 net profit of S\$1,338mn, -5% yoy/-10% qoq, -6% vs. GSe (see [First Take: 2Q25 weaker vs GSe on weaker non-NII and higher CoC; Core interim dividend lower at 85cents](#)). UOB released new guidance that was generally weaker across operating lines, and lowered medium term ROE target to 12%-13% from previous 14% for 2026, amid the slower growth and lower rate environment. We revise down our 2025/26/27E net income estimates by -2.4%/-2.2%/-2.4% to S\$5,550/S\$5,961/ S\$6,389mn as we lower non-NII income and increase credit costs for 2025, while the lower NIM guidance is already modeled in our forecasts. We now forecast ROE of 11.5%/12.0%/12.3% for 2025-27E. Another key focus at the analyst briefing was if UOB would hold 2025 DPS flat, particularly in light of the downward pressure in EPS. UOB currently affirms its commitment to a 50% DPO, but we do see scope for the bank to hold DPS flat with its fully-loaded CET1 ratio robust at 15.1% at 2Q25. We forecast DPS of S\$ 1.80/1.86/2.00 for 2025-27E, implying DPO of 55%/51%/51%, with the 2025 forecast slightly exceeding the bank's historical 51% level. In addition, UOB mentioned it will consider further capital return plan after completion of the share buyback plan.

Overall, we view this set of results as muted, notably lacking clear commitment to flat DPS payout in 2025. Following the results announcement, UOB's share price declined 2% today and we expect it could remain muted in the near term. However, we still see UOB as capable of delivering flat DPS based on its robust capital level and delivering ROE of 12% by 2026E. We remain Buy on UOB. Post results, we revise down our 12-m 2-stage DDM target price to S\$42.7 from S\$44.7.

More details from the briefing:

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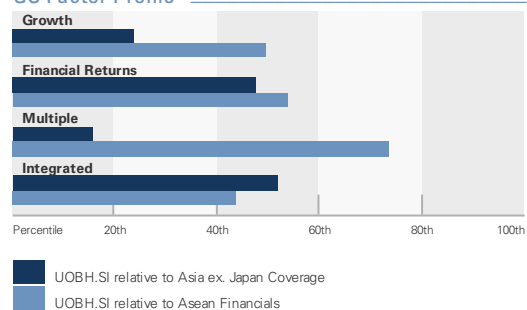
Key Data

Market cap: S\$59.4bn / \$46.2bn
3m ADTV: S\$104.7mn / \$81.4mn
Singapore
Asean Financials
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net inc. (S\$ mn) New	6,044.0	5,550.1	5,960.7	6,389.2
Net inc. (S\$ mn) Old	6,044.0	5,686.5	6,094.4	6,549.6
EPS (S\$) New	3.51	3.28	3.52	3.78
EPS (S\$) Old	3.51	3.36	3.60	3.88
EPS growth (%)	6.0	(6.8)	7.6	7.3
P/E (X)	8.9	10.9	10.2	9.5
P/B (X)	1.1	1.2	1.2	1.1
Price/PPOP (X)	7.2	7.6	7.3	6.8
Dividend yield (%)	7.3	5.0	5.2	5.6
	3/25	6/25E	9/25E	12/25E
EPS (S\$)	0.88	0.77	0.82	0.78

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

Buy

United Overseas Bank (UOBH.SI)

Rating since Nov 10, 2024

Ratios & Valuation

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
P/E (X)	8.9	10.9	10.2	9.5
Price/PPOP (X)	7.2	7.6	7.3	6.8
P/B (X)	1.1	1.2	1.2	1.1
P/NTA per share (X)	—	—	—	—
Dividend yield (%)	7.3	5.0	5.2	5.6
Div. payout ratio (%)	64.2	53.8	51.0	51.0

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
BVPS growth	8.1	3.2	5.4	6.3
Total revenue growth	2.6	(2.6)	3.1	5.7
Op. profit growth	0.8	(4.9)	4.7	6.9
Net inc growth	5.8	(8.2)	7.4	7.2
EPS growth	6.0	(6.8)	7.6	7.3
DPS growth	35.3	(21.7)	3.5	7.2

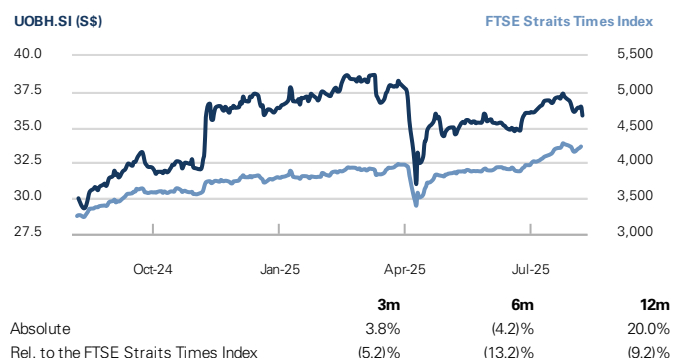
Asset Quality

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Provision charge/total loans (%)	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3
Gr impaired assets/total loans (%)	1.5	1.6	1.6	1.7
NPL ratio (%)	1.5	1.6	1.6	1.7
Total provisions/total loans (%)	1.2	1.1	1.2	1.2
Specific prov/gr impair assets (%)	31.7	22.8	22.6	22.8
Loan loss reserve/NPLs (%)	75.5	69.1	70.9	71.6

Capital Item

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Basel 3 CET1 ratio (%)	—	—	—	—
Tier 1 capital ratio (%)	16.6	16.1	16.2	16.6

Price Performance



Source: FactSet. Price as of 7 Aug 2025 close.

Income Statement (\$\$ mn)

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net interest income	9,675.0	9,294.8	9,304.9	9,726.1
Net fees	2,395.0	2,633.2	2,946.6	3,274.6
Treasury income	1,689.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other operating income	535.0	1,992.0	2,096.0	2,161.1
Total revenue	14,294.0	13,920.1	14,347.6	15,161.9
Compensation & benefits exp.	(3,699.0)	—	—	—
Non-employee costs	(2,376.0)	(6,105.4)	(6,166.4)	(6,413.1)
Pre-provision op. profit	8,219.0	7,814.7	8,181.1	8,748.8
Provision for loans	(873.0)	(1,098.7)	(1,065.5)	(1,121.1)
Total provision expense	(926.0)	(1,125.7)	(1,065.5)	(1,121.1)
Income/(loss) from associates	121.0	60.0	84.0	88.2
Pre-tax profit	7,151.0	6,732.0	7,199.7	7,715.9
Provision for taxes	(1,092.0)	(1,166.9)	(1,223.9)	(1,311.7)
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	6,044.0	5,550.1	5,960.7	6,389.2
Post-tax exceptionals	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	5,925.7	5,431.8	5,842.4	6,270.9
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (\$\$)	3.58	3.35	3.65	3.92
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (basic, post-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (diluted, post-exception) (\$\$)	3.51	3.28	3.52	3.78
Wtd avg shares out. (diluted) (mn)	1,685.9	1,657.9	1,657.9	1,657.9
Avg. yield on loans (%)	5.2	4.5	4.2	4.1
Gr yld. on int. earning assets (%)	4.6	4.0	3.6	3.5
Cost of fund (%)	3.0	2.4	2.0	1.9
Net interest margin (%)	1.9	1.8	1.8	1.8

Balance Sheet (\$\$ mn)

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Domestic mortgages	82,036.0	84,931.0	89,158.3	94,638.7
Domestic non-mortgages	29,914.0	30,022.9	31,517.3	33,454.6
Domestic commercial lending	206,447.0	212,663.2	223,248.1	236,971.0
Total overseas lending, gross	—	—	—	—
Gross loans to customers	337,831.0	348,860.0	366,223.8	388,735.3
Total NPLs, gross	5,164.0	5,681.4	6,037.5	6,486.3
Total loan loss reserve	3,901.0	3,927.7	4,278.1	4,644.2
Net customer loans & advances	333,930.0	344,932.3	361,945.8	384,091.1
Other interest earning assets	85,943.0	92,164.3	94,178.8	96,276.3
Interest earning assets	509,163.0	514,455.2	535,260.5	558,732.0
Other non-int. earning assets	28,501.0	29,908.1	29,828.6	29,745.1
Total assets	537,664.0	544,363.2	565,089.1	588,477.1
Risk weighted assets	259,835.0	269,100.7	279,346.3	290,907.9
CASA deposits	220,644.0	236,860.2	252,614.4	269,626.7
Non-CASA deposits	183,334.0	174,663.1	177,832.4	181,065.2
Customer deposits	403,978.0	411,523.3	430,446.8	450,691.9
Other paying liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other liabilities	19,879.0	21,791.0	21,791.0	21,791.0
Total liabilities	487,707.0	493,712.3	512,635.8	532,880.9
Total shareholders' equity	49,957.0	50,650.9	52,453.3	55,596.2
Total liabilities & equity	537,664.0	544,363.2	565,089.1	588,477.1
BVPS (\$\$)	27.87	28.75	30.31	32.23
RWA/assets (%)	48.3	49.4	49.4	49.4

Profit Drivers

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net customer loan growth (%)	5.3	3.3	4.9	6.1
Net interest margin (%)	1.9	1.8	1.8	1.8
Fee income ratio (%)	NM	NM	NM	NM
Cost/income (ex. goodwill) (%)	42.3	43.7	43.0	42.3
Tax rate (%)	15.3	17.3	17.0	17.0
CASA ratio (%)	54.6	57.6	58.7	59.8
Net cust. loans/deposits (%)	82.7	83.8	84.1	85.2

Profitability

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Op. revenue/avg. assets (%)	2.7	2.6	2.6	2.6
Op. expenses/avg. assets (%)	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1
Pre-provision ROA (%)	1.5	1.4	1.5	1.5
Loan loss prov./avg. assets (%)	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2
Pre-tax profit/avg. assets (%)	1.3	1.2	1.3	1.3
Prov. for inc. tax/avg. assets (%)	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2
ROA (%)	1.1	1.0	1.1	1.1
Leverage (X)	10.8	10.7	10.8	10.6
ROE (%)	13.1	11.5	12.0	12.3
ROE (pre-exception.) (%)	12.5	11.0	11.6	11.8

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

- **Focus on NII management with NIM guidance of 1.85%-1.90% and loan growth guidance of low-single digits.** With 2Q25 exit NIM of 1.84%, UOB expects 2H25 NIM to be supported by funding cost management with full impact of deposit account rate cuts in May and Aug to be materialized. The guidance is based on assumption of 3 Fed rate cuts, with a more moderate pass through into 3M SORA to 1.7% by 2025 end from current 1.8%, and a recovery of 1M HIBOR to 1.6% from current 1.0%. On loan growth, UOB lowered guidance to low-single digits from previous high-single digits, attributed to reduced demand in a slower growth environment and the bank's strategic focus on quality. We forecast NIM of 1.89% and loan growth of 3%, and NII growth of -4%.
- **Asset quality remains steady and will continue to build GP.** UOB noted the higher NPA formation and higher SP of 32bps in 2Q was largely due to downgrade of a US CRE corporate account which had been pre-emptively provisioned in GP. UOB also stated that its total exposure to US property is only 0.8% of total portfolio, including office, family homes and industrial logistics. Overall UOB sees its asset quality as steady, despite a small uptick in mortgage NPL coming from Thailand. UOB guides net credit cost of 25-30bps for 2025, and will continue to build GP, aiming to increase GP to total loan coverage to 90bps, from current 80bps, in the medium term. We forecast credit cost of 32bps for 2025.
- **ROE target of 12%-13% for the medium term,** lowered from previous target of 14% for 2026. UOB explained that the previous target released in Aug 2024 was based on higher GDP and policy rate assumptions, which no longer hold in the current environment. UOB did not affirm if this ROE target does bake in additional capital return plans other than the announced S\$3.0bn return plan vs previously where it noted that further capital optimization was part of its 14% target. For 2025 UOB expects to support profitability with strong fee income (guiding high-single-digit growth in 2025) attributable to sustained decent wealth fees which saw decent net new money of S\$3bn in 2Q25, as well as credit card fees on the back of increasing lifestyle offerings. UOB also supports profitability with prudent cost management, expecting flattish opex in 2025. We forecast ROE of 11.5% for 2025, fee growth of 10% and opex growth of 0.5%. In the medium term, UOB sees ROEs to be helped by enhancing CASA mix, growth in its wealth platform, revenue synergies on its customer base as well as leveraging regional banking platform etc.
- **Stick to 50% dividend payout, while we remain hopeful for flat DPS.** UOB is committed to maintaining a 50% dividend payout ratio, a DPO consistently delivered over recent years through economic cycles. However, they did note that the dividend will be reviewed at the end of the year. We do see scope for the bank to hold DPS flat given robust capital levels with its fully-loaded CET1 ratio robust at 15.1% at 2Q25. We forecast DPS of S\$ 1.80/1.86/2.00 for 2025-27E, and we removed our previous assumption of S\$0.5 special dividend to be announced at end 2025E, given our view that there is slight change in willingness to add to its capital returns program before it completes. This would imply DPO of 55%/51%/51%, with the 2025 forecast slightly exceeding the bank's historical 51% level. However, we see hope for more with, UOB commenting it may consider further buyback return plan after completion of its current share buyback plan.

Key risks: (-) Unexpected acceleration or deeper Fed rate cuts; (-) Poor execution of growth strategy in Citi franchise; (-) Unexpected deterioration in asset quality.

Exhibit 1: UOB 2025 Results Summary

Income statement (\$\$mn)						Actual vs. Est			
	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	2Q25E	(%)
Net Interest Income	2,401	2,460	2,452	2,409	2,336	(3)	(3)	2,298	2
Fee & Commission	618	630	567	694	636	3	(8)	680	(6)
Other Non-Interest Income	457	744	442	554	493	8	(11)	514	(4)
Non-Interest Income	1,075	1,374	1,009	1,248	1,129	5	(10)	1,194	(5)
Operating Income	3,476	3,834	3,461	3,657	3,465	(0)	(5)	3,492	(1)
Operating Expenses	(1,451)	(1,590)	(1,559)	(1,559)	(1,536)	6	(1)	(1,557)	(1)
Pre-Prov Op Profit (PPOP)	2,025	2,244	1,902	2,098	1,929	(5)	(8)	1,935	(0)
Loan Loss Provisions	(232)	(304)	(227)	(290)	(279)	20	(4)	(258)	8
Pre-tax Profit	1,718	1,923	1,685	1,822	1,638	(5)	(10)	1,722	(5)
Net Profit	1,410	1,610	1,522	1,490	1,338	(5)	(10)	1,425	(6)
Balance sheet (\$\$mn)									
Assets	516,743	541,885	537,664	538,009	537,838	4	(0)	543,940	(1)
Gross Loans	327,600	333,998	337,831	341,154	342,900	4.7	0.5	345,269	(1)
Non-Performing Loans	4,888	5,010	5,164	5,458	5,341	9	(2)	5,450	(2)
Customer Deposits	389,157	400,784	403,978	401,250	405,076	4	1	408,210	(1)
CAMEL Ratios (%)									
Core Tier 1	13.4	15.2	15.4	15.4	15.1			14.9	
NPL Ratio	1.49	1.50	1.53	1.60	1.56			1.58	
Provisions / Average Loans (bps)	29	37	27	34	33			30	
Reported Net Interest Margin	2.05	2.05	2.00	2.00	1.91			1.90	
Cost-to-Income Ratio	41.7	41.5	45.0	42.6	44.3			44.6	
Loan-to-Deposits	84.2	83.3	83.6	85.0	84.7			84.6	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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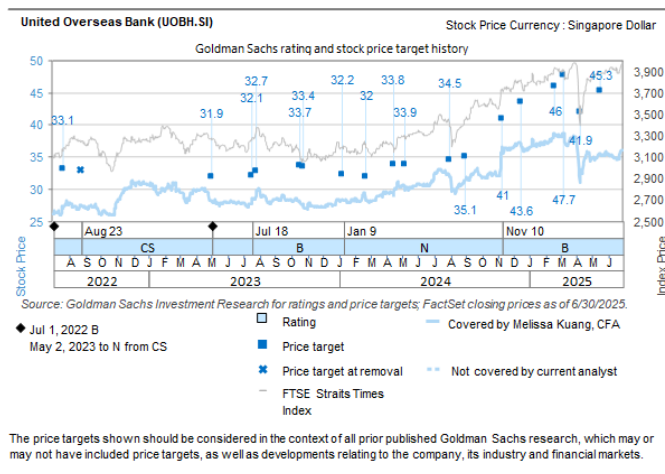
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	Buy	Hold	Sell	Buy	Hold	Sell
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



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